

Order of Adjectives

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Adjectives before a noun follow a usual order. A common sequence is:

- 1 opinion → size → age → shape → colour → origin → material → purpose → NOUN.
- 2 Example: a beautiful small old round black Italian leather bag.
- 3 Opinion first (lovely, nice); material/purpose last, next to the noun.

You rarely use all of these at once. With two or three, keep the same order: a big red car, an old wooden box.

At a glance

Order	Type	Examples
1	opinion	lovely, nice, horrible
2	size	big, small, tall
3	age	old, new, young
4	shape	round, square, flat
5	colour	red, black, green
6	origin	Italian, French
7	material	wooden, leather, plastic
8	purpose	running (shoes), sports (bag)

Learning objectives

- Can order adjectives before a noun using the usual sequence (CEFR B1).
- Can place opinion adjectives before fact adjectives.
- Can put material/purpose adjectives next to the noun.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Order of Adjectives · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. She wore a ____ dress.

- A. lovely red
- B. red lovely
- C. lovely, red-ish well
- D. red, lovely

2. They live in a ____ house.

- A. big old
- B. old big
- C. big, old-ish
- D. old, big well

3. He bought a ____ table.

- A. round wooden
- B. wooden round
- C. wood round
- D. round, wooden-ish

4. I need a ____ bag.

- A. small black leather
- B. leather black small
- C. black small leather
- D. leather small black

5. What a ____ cat!

- A. cute little white
- B. white little cute
- C. little cute white
- D. white cute little

6. She drives an ____ car.

- A. expensive new Italian
- B. Italian new expensive
- C. new expensive Italian
- D. Italian expensive new

7. We sat at a ____ table.

- A. long narrow wooden
- B. wooden narrow long
- C. narrow wooden long
- D. wooden long narrow

8. Correct this: 'a red beautiful jumper'

- A. a beautiful red jumper
- B. a red beautiful jumper
- C. a beautiful, red-ish jumper
- D. a jumper beautiful red

9. Correct this: 'a plastic small box'

- A. a small plastic box
- B. a plastic small box
- C. a small, plastic-ish box
- D. a box small plastic

10. Which type of adjective usually comes FIRST?

- A. opinion
- B. material
- C. colour
- D. origin

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. lovely red** — Opinion before colour: 'a lovely red dress'.
2. **A. big old** — Size before age: 'a big old house'.
3. **A. round wooden** — Shape before material: 'a round wooden table'.
4. **A. small black leather** — Size → colour → material: 'a small black leather bag'.
5. **A. cute little white** — Opinion → size → colour: 'a cute little white cat'.
6. **A. expensive new Italian** — Opinion → age → origin: 'an expensive new Italian car'.
7. **A. long narrow wooden** — Size → shape → material: 'a long narrow wooden table'.
8. **A. a beautiful red jumper** — Opinion before colour: 'a beautiful red jumper'.
9. **A. a small plastic box** — Size before material: 'a small plastic box'.
10. **A. opinion** — Opinion adjectives come first (lovely, nice).